GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

September 19th, 2025
Week 38
Volume 276, Issue 1203

Highlights:

- **Stability returns.**
- **Market focus.**
- **LNGs steady.**
- **Average older.**
- **Volatile still.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"The most difficult thing is the decision to act; the rest is merely tenacity."

– Amelia Earhart

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

Click "Ctrl" + below to launch the GMS Weekly Summary Podcast

SEPTEMBER SERENE?

After what seemed like months of unstoppable volatility, a modicum of stability seemed to enter the global trading markets this week as oil climbed marginally (0.17%) before the week ended, yet this remains a near 1.4% drop just this month and a 10.8% overall decline from the same time last year. On the flip side, trading markets continue to edge on as they surged another 3.6% this week, but the Baltic Exchange Dry Index reported both Panamax and Supramax indices dipping nearly 2% and 3% respectively, while the Cape index, which has been carrying the bulk of the dry index sector, climbed nearly 1% this week.

With minimal news emanating from the White House over the last couple of weeks and an ongoing status quo on state of warring nations, the mild serenity of the international markets found itself trickling down to the Indian sub-continent ship recycling locations as well this week, after what has been months of negative spirals that most destinations have endured over these summer / monsoon / recent months. Not only did local steel plate prices continue to flatline (remain optimistically steady?) across most locations, but even the U.S. Dollar seemed to weaken against key currencies this week, except for Turkey's perennial landslide where its Lira is concerned. Supply too seems to have firmed a touch at the bidding tables of late, as recycling destinations continue to demonstrate the inflow of tonnage, while others languish in the obscurity on the availability of the types of units to bid on – and their subsequently willingness to engage on said units.

A majority of the slim collection of recent market sales remained focused on India, with Pakistan and (especially) Bangladesh still struggling to summon any coherent offerings or a clear buying at present, even for those vessels that are literally positioned in their backyard or sailing in from Far East locations. India meanwhile has cornered virtually all of the year's LNG recycling sales, which have remained sporadically, yet mercifully steady over the last quarters (and indeed for much of the year), as other categories have clearly remained tied up in their respective trading lanes - given the performance of various indices over all of 2025.

As such, the average age of operating vessels has gradually increased with the draw of the Dollar from re-employment, with bulkers, containers and certain categories of tankers now often passing 30 years of age again. And while local market fundamentals do remain volatile, regulatory (HKC implementation) struggles continue to challenge a Pakistan market that desperately needs to catch up with yard infrastructure work. Turkey at the far end remains stranded in recycling oblivion out of necessity, then choice.

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 38 of 2025 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

SPORADIC!

No equation.

Demand, and subsequently local offerings from Bangladesh have turned even more sporadic over the last month, certainly since September transitioned in and this is surprising most in the industry given that post-monsoon trends in the ship-recycling industry have historically been on the up. As most units on offer have been smaller LDT vessels that have been increasingly less fancied by local recyclers and have simply not received any attention (let alone offers) whatsoever – and logically so.

Ratio of efforts.

Not only has the HKC turned import regulations and import control into a guaranteed session of rush hour traffic delays and headaches, but the Cirque Du Soleil of hoops that local recyclers now have to jump through (e.g., mandatory HKC yard / infrastructure upgrades) and continue to jump through (e.g., new documentary requirements and inward permissions) in order to simply import a vessel for recycling, has permeated a sense of disinterest towards smaller LDT units as the effort to import such small sizes doesn't match the ratio of efforts for local recyclers at present .

As a result, most Chattogram Choppers (like the Gadani Gang) are electing to focus on larger LDT units that not only make sense to put their efforts into, but will also keep them pre-occupied longer than they would otherwise have to with smaller units, before they have to return to the bidding tables and repeat the frustrating process of fresh permissions on the next unit, all over again. Juicy LNGs have meanwhile been receiving a flurry of local interest and competitive offers, but with the limited number of units making the rounds has left such interest on the selective and subdued side - primarily depending on the availability of a local recycler.

Trump-o-nomics!

Problems also persist with recycled ship's steel failing to shift from end buyer yards due to an ailing economy and lack of any infrastructure projects emanating from the thralls of the interim regime that seems to have driven the country further down the stability ladder - although inflation has steadily retreated over preceding months as it ended August at 8.29% down from 9.8% just a few months ago).

Election hopes.

Trump-o-nomics has also not spared the Taka from dithering across the year as after declining in segments across various quarters, it ended the week subdued at BDT 121.74, while local steel plate prices flatlined (or remained steady, depending on if your glass is half full or half empty) at a healthy USD 519/Ton. Local port position meanwhile escaped isolation as another fresh candidate greeted the waterfront, with the arrival of a decent LDT tanker.

Overall, as all eyes and all hopes remain posted on the upcoming elections in February 2026 when a change in leadership could bring with it renewed optimism and momentum following a dull and damp last year or so for the country, in the interim, this market seems destined to go through an extended period on the sidelines.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

SUSPECT IMPORTS!

Alang's port report remains the busiest of all sub-continent ship recycling destinations, thanks in small part to the recent arrival of a few OFAC listed / sanctioned units that were otherwise turned away by competing locations who did chose not to violate international sanctions or regulations. And all of this comes at a time PM Modi is planning a visit to Bhavnagar this week, leading to all in the region turning busy to welcome the nation's leader in his home State of Gujarat, resulting in a partial shutdown across much of the state and even Alang.

Listed arrivals.

This alleged activity in the trade of sanctioned vessels by cash buyers has landed India in trouble with the U.S. and Trump in particular, who has raised all manner of sanctions and tariffs against India in order to try and deter their business dealings with perceived rogue regimes, over and above Trump's distaste of India's decades long oil trade with Russia, who he is clearly unable to control given the mounting pressure from Western States.

Sanctions raised.

All of this has culminated into an India Rupee that has crashed all across August and more notably in September as it broke past prior records against the US. Dollar while mercifully (and finally) firming 21 basis points to end this week at Rs. 88.09. Local steel plate prices also started to mirror neighbouring competitors as they flatlined for the consecutive 3rd week in a row, at the sub-continent's lowest levels at USD 448/Ton.

Yet, this has not deterred local interest to the extent otherwise feared and with HKC wings already primed for afterburner given Alang's decade long expertise in the game, local anchorage has continued to outperform competitors for nearly two months now and even this week, with a healthy batch of arrivals and nearly 84K LDT of tonnage idling at anchorage / delivered locally. And while larger LDT favoured LNGs rich in nonferrous have been the juiciest flavour of the year, they have also been able to command a significant premium for their owners, a blessing considering the state of declining prices since January 2024.

Historical decline.

Overall, despite the recent historical and concerning decline in the Indian Rupee, demand and purchases have certainly steadied / stabilised in Alang of late and especially this week.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

CURIOUSLY CONFUSED!

Heading elsewhere.

It is curious to see the leading ship recycling market (pricewise) in the world celebrate an empty port report for the third straight week in a row, given that much of the nonferrous and larger LDT LNG / LPG tonnage remains focused on India (including clearly OFAC listed / sanctioned tankers as well, several of which reportedly remain arrested outside Alang).

Moreover, and as highlighted in the Bangladesh section above, Pakistani ship recyclers have not been keen to import small(er) LDT units on account of their exclusive (and painful) issuances of DASR certificates that permit them to import vessels. But in Pakistan, their problems is magnitudes greater as not a single ship recycling yard is HKC certified as yet, while DASR issuances are reportedly being made to only those yard owners who continue to demonstrate ongoing upgrades and improvements at their respective yards.

Shunning small LDT.

As a result, even to merely get a "provisional" DASR certificate to continue operating in Gadani has left the Gadani Gang focusing primarily on importing larger LDT vessels that may come around. Unfortunately for them and as has been evident from ongoing port reports, most large LDT units have primarily been LNGs / non-ferrous vessels that have perennially remained an "India only" domain for nearly 2 decades – and the fact that Pakistan banned LNGs circa 2007.

In Gadani nevertheless, HKC yard upgrades are ongoing and reportedly at pace. And if their fundamentals continue to support their ongoing price levels – the PKR firming 18 basis points against the U.S. Dollar closing the week out at PKR 283.44 and local steel plate prices stagnating at the highest levels in the industry at USD 623/Ton (despite declining a comparatively marginal USD 4/Ton and still closing the week out USD 619/Ton) - Pakistan remains geared to be an industry leader, so as long as levels hold and HKC yards start to come online.

Work to do.

Work remains to be done, but with weeks of empty port reports and ongoing progress at local yards, Pakistan may just take off before the end of the year – watch this space.

Watch this space.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

SILENT SLIDE!

Turkey has remained silent and sliding for over 24 months now and this week, import steel plate prices fell for the 2nd week in a row, the Lira slid 15 basis points to end the week at TRY 41.41 against the U.S. Dollar, and local port position reportedly remained famished.

All of the red-tape and regulations meant for good cause has only ruptured the fate of an entire industry.

Ruptured.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 38 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	**Steady**	420 / LDT	440 / LDT	450 / LDT
2	India	**Steady**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
3	Bangladesh	**Weak**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Weak**	250 / LDT	260 / LDT	270 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- *On average, lightning strikes Earth 100 times per second.*
- *It saddens me to report that Winnie the Pooh was banned from a Polish playground because the honey-obsessed bear doesn't wear pants. As if it's his fault!*
- *Attempting to get kids to eat more vegetables, McDonald's engineer bubblegum-flavored broccoli. Unsurprisingly, it wasn't a hit.*
- *Blue whales are the baddies of the ocean (sorry, orcas), and if I were a sea creature, I would never, ever tussle with one, especially considering a blue whale's tongue alone can weigh more than an elephant.*
- *Due to their genes, redheads may need about 20% more anesthesia than non-redheads.*
- *I literally never thought about Barbie being called anything other than Barbie, but her full name is Barbara Millicent Roberts.*
- *There are more possible chess game variations than atoms in the universe.*
- *The warty comb jellyfish doesn't have an anus, so when it needs to poop, its gut fuses with an outer layer of its "skin" to create a hole in its body. After the deed is done, the hole closes right back up.*
- *In Thailand, there's an annual Monkey Buffet Festival where residents of Lopburi leave 4.5 tons of fruit, veggies, and other treats to honor the approximately 3,000 monkeys that live near the Phra Prang Sam Yot temple. Way better than Coachella, don't you think?*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
October 02 – Dussehra / Gandhi Jayanthi October 03 – Durga Puja October 22 – Diwali	September 19 – September 27 October 05 – October 13 October 20 – October 26

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
October 01 & 02 – Durga Puja	September 20 – September 23 October 06 – October 09 October 20 – October 23

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
October 24 – Founding Day	October 28 & 29 – Republic Day

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of September 19, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Bonita	10,201	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 18
2	*Coal II*	*14,840*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered September 17*
3	**Conica Atlas**	**20,001**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived June 13**
4	Gas Pioneer	1,140	LPG	Arrived September 17
5	Kavita	6,614	General Cargo	Arrived September 16
6	**Nirvana**	**9,623**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived May 07**
7	*Pione*	*10,129*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered September 17*
8	Rising Eagle	5,440	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 18
9	*Rising Falcon*	*5,964*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered September 18*
Total Tonnage		**83,952**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of September 19, 2025

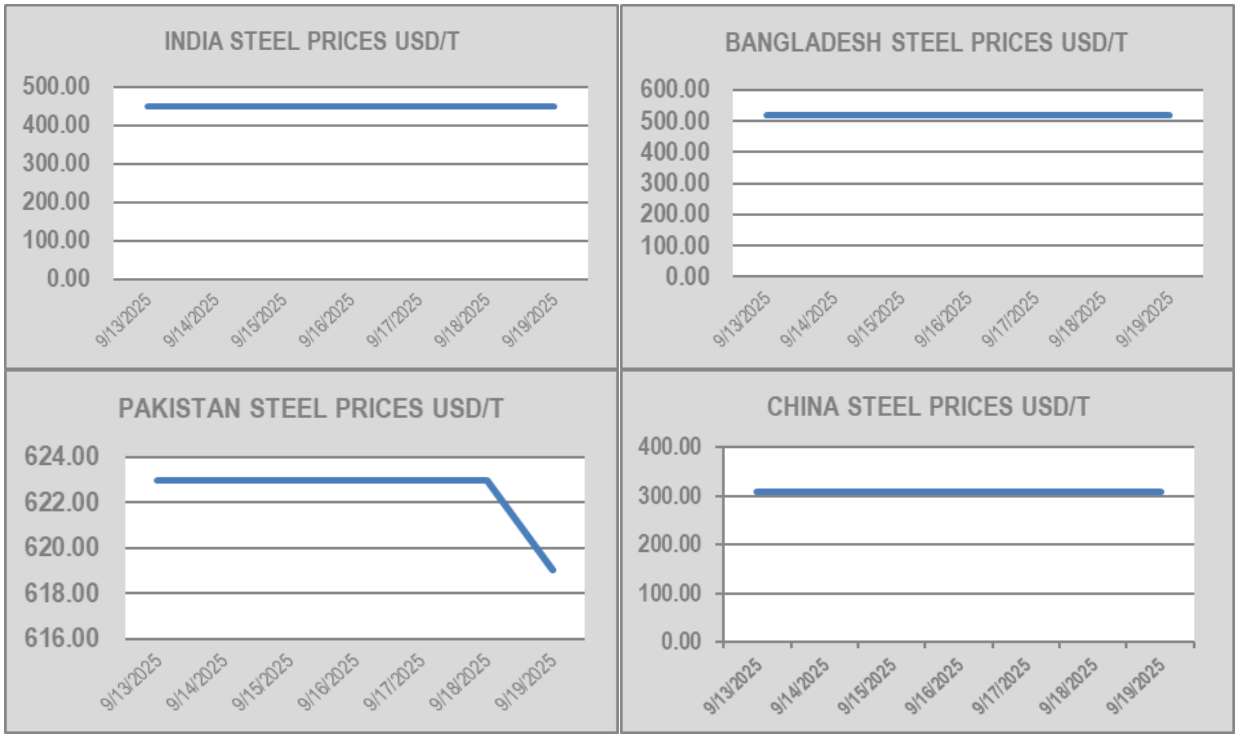
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Crystal	7,052	Tanker	Arrived September 17
2	DK 03	7,809	Bulk Carrier	Arrived August 04
3	Rade	29,941	LNG Carrier	Delivered September 21
		44,802		

GADANI - Port Position as of September 19, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
		No vessels reported.		
Total Tonnage		**-**		

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
9/13/2025	448.88	37,900.00	623.01	176,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/14/2025	448.88	37,900.00	623.01	176,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/15/2025	448.88	37,800.00	623.01	176,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/16/2025	448.88	37,600.00	623.01	176,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/17/2025	448.88	37,600.00	623.01	176,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/18/2025	448.88	37,400.00	623.01	176,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/19/2025	448.88	37,400.00	619.03	175,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17



ANDROID APP ON Google play
Download on the App Store

www.gmsinc.net
GMS_Leadership
GMS Leadership
snp@gmsinc.net

Athens, Greece Tel: +30.210.899.0669
Cumberland, USA Tel: +1.301.759.9240
Hamburg, Germany Tel: +49.40. 3197.9963
Shanghai, China Tel: +86.216.075.1900
Singapore Tel: +65.6823.8037
Bhavnagar, India Tel: +91.278.300.5253
Dubai, UAE Tel: +971.4.423.0720
New York, USA: +1.240.505.9716
Seoul, South Korea Tel: +82.10.4650.0720
Tokyo, Japan Tel: +81.3.5453.6311